

API2Test — Installation Guide

Installing the API2Test extension for Visual Studio Code

Prerequisites

- **Visual Studio Code 1.74** or later.
- **.NET 8 SDK** — only needed to build/run the generated C# test projects.
- The bundled **Api2Test.vsix** package (in this repository).

Option A — Install from the command line

With the VS Code **code** command on your PATH, run:

```
code --install-extension Api2Test.vsix
```

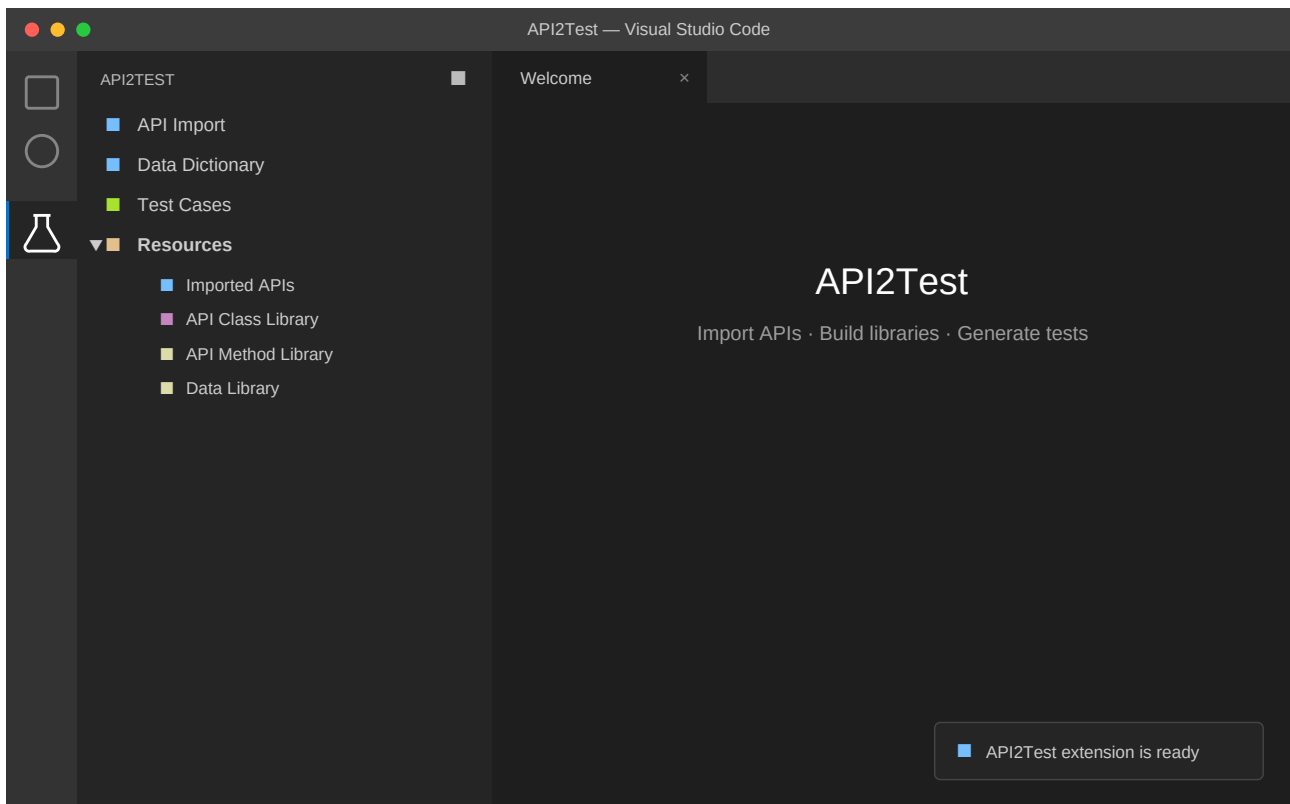
Restart VS Code if prompted.

Option B — Install from the VS Code UI

Step	Action
1	Open the Extensions view (Ctrl+Shift+X).
2	Click the “...” (More Actions) menu at the top of the view.
3	Choose “Install from VSIX...”.
4	Select Api2Test.vsix from this repository.
5	Reload VS Code when prompted.

Verify the installation

- A **flask icon** appears in the Activity Bar (left edge).
- Clicking it opens the **API2Test** panel with API Import, Data Dictionary, Test Cases and Resources.
- A notification reads “**API2Test extension is ready**”.



Where your data is stored

API2Test keeps its data as JSON files under `~/.vscode/API2Test/data/`. These are created automatically on first run and are never overwritten, so upgrades preserve your applications, libraries and data dictionary.

Updating

Install a newer Api2Test.vsix the same way — your data directory is left intact. To remove the extension, open the Extensions view, find API2Test, and click Uninstall.

Troubleshooting

- **“code” not recognised** — in VS Code run “Shell Command: Install 'code' command in PATH”, or use Option B.
- **Extension fails to activate** — open Help → Toggle Developer Tools and check the Console, or Output → API2Test.
- **VSIX rejected as incompatible** — confirm VS Code is version 1.74 or later (Help → About).